

TOPIC 6 : American Period

List of Reading Materials:

- 1. Treaty of Paris**
- 2. McKinley's Prayer**
- 3. Benevolent Assimilation Proclamation**
- 4. Our Campaign for Independence**
- 5. The Corner Stone of Philippine Independence**
- 6. The Jones Law of 1916**
- 7. The Philippine Organic Act of 1902**
- 8. Diary of Carrie Chapman**
- 9. The Philippine Independence Act**

152

INTRODUCTORY ESSAY FOR THE AMERICAN PERIOD IN THE PHILIPPINES

The readings are designed to offer to the students the primary sources that will provide them the context to be able to understand the narrative of the American occupation of the Philippines. Presented in chronological order, the collection will let them read first the "Treaty of Paris of December 10, 1898." This peace agreement allowed the United States to gain possession of the Philippine Islands. The next reading material is "McKinley's Prayer." The significance of this excerpt is that it gives an insider's view of how President McKinley arrived at his decision to issue his famous "Benevolent Assimilation" Policy. Citing that it was God's will that the US should annex the Philippine Islands after praying hard supported the idea that occupying the Philippine islands had a blessing from God and should be seen from the vantage point of the Christian zeal of missionary work by way of spreading the good news to the natives of the archipelago. The Philippine Bill of 1902 guides the students to appreciate one of the most important decrees enacted by the American government in the Philippines. They will realize that the most important element contained in the bill was the clause that called for the creation of a lower legislative branch with elected Filipino representatives as legislators that will comprise the Philippine Assembly. The next reading presents an excerpt of Gov. General Francis Burton Harrison. This reading depicts the personal view of Harrison on the Filipino leaders and politicians who were emerging as the new leaders of the government as well as the challenges he faced in administering the colony. Following this excerpt is another excerpt from a book written by Filipinos Palma and Kalaw that provides clear insights and details on why the respective political parties were organized including the discussion of their political platforms.

The Jones Law of 1916 is the first formal and official declaration of the United States' commitment to grant independence to the Philippines. This Law replaced the Philippine Organic Act of 1902 (Philippine Bill of July 1, 1902) that served as the de facto initial constitution of the Philippine Islands. The emphasis of this reading is the fact that among the salient provisions of the Autonomy Act of 1916 was the creation of an all Filipino legislature which created the Philippine Senate to replace the Philippine Commission which had served as the upper chamber of the legislature. The next reading is an excerpt from the diary of Carrie Chapman Catt which led to the creation of a movement for women to take up leadership roles in politics. Lastly, a significant reading material for students to read about the American Period is the text of the Tydings-McDuffie Act of 1934. Known as the Philippine Independence Act of 1934, this was a U.S. law that provided for Philippine independence. Because of this, the Filipinos will now be motivated to prepare for the establishment of the Commonwealth government..

153

Treaty of Peace between the United States of America and the Kingdom of Spain (Treaty of Paris), signed in Paris, December 10, 1898

By the President of the United States of America

[Signed in Paris, December 10, 1898]

ANNOTATION

The Treaty of Paris, signed on December 10, 1898, was a peace agreement between Spain and the United States that ended the Spanish-American War. Under the treaty, Cuba gained independence from Spain, and the United States gained possession of the Philippine Islands, Puerto Rico, other islands in the West Indies, and Guam.

The commission met from October to December 1898 and agreed upon that some colonies of Spain including the Philippines be ceded to the United States. On 10 December 1898, without Filipino representation and consultation, the Treaty of Paris was concluded. It was signed by representatives from the US Government namely: Cushman Davis, William Frye, Whitelaw Reid, George Gray, and William Day. The Spanish delegation on the other hand was composed of Eugenio Montero Rios, Buenaventura Abarzuza, Jose de Garnica, Wenceslao Ramirez de Villa-Urrutia, and Rafael Cerero.

The Treaty of Paris was made up of thirteen articles that stipulate the conditions, obligations, as well as benefits that the Governments of Spain and the United States could enjoy over the ceded islands. It also stated that an amount of \$20, 000,000 will be paid by the US to Spain after the treaty's ratification.

The treaty did not go into effect until after its ratification. Initially, many American senators did not favor it for they thought of it as unfair to the Filipinos and a manifestation of imperialism. Unfortunately, the Filipino-American hostilities that erupted on 4 February 1899 in the Philippines (known as the "First Shot") changed the course of the tide. American propaganda made it appear that the Filipinos instigated the hostility causing the breach of alliance and trust. Two days after, the treaty was ratified with two-thirds of the majority in the US Senate.

The American and Spanish governments reckoned the Treaty of Paris as an instrument of Peace, but the

Filipinos resented its conclusion and ratification for they were not consulted and considered in its making. Further, the provisions of the treaty were not for the benefit of the Filipinos but the imperialists, instead. With the signing and ratification of the Treaty of Paris, the bitter relations between the Americans and the Filipinos turned bitterer and eventually lead to another episode that was known as the Filipino-American

A Proclamation.

Whereas, a Treaty of Peace between the United States of America and Her Majesty the Queen Regent of Spain, in the name of her August Son, Don Alfonso XIII, was concluded and signed by their respective plenipotentiaries at Paris on the tenth day of December, 1898, the original of which Convention being in the English and Spanish languages, is word for word as follows:

THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA AND HER MAJESTY THE QUEEN REGENT OF SPAIN, IN THE NAME OF HER AUGUST SON DON ALFONSO XIII, desiring to end the

154

state of war now existing between the two countries, have for that purpose appointed as Plenipotentiaries:

THE PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES,
WILLIAM R. DAY, CUSHMAN K. DAVIS, WILLIAM P. FRYE, GEORGE GRAY, and
WHITELAW REID, citizens of the United States;

AND HER MAJESTY THE QUEEN REGENT OF SPAIN,
DON EUGENIO MONTERO RIOS, President of the Senate
DON BUENAVENTURA De ABARZUZA, Senator of the Kingdom and ex-Minister of the Crown,
DON JOSE DE GARNICA, Deputy to the Cortes and Associate Justice of the Supreme Court;
DON WENCESLAO RAMIREZ DE VILLA-URRUTIA, Envoy Extraordinary and Minister Plenipotentiary at Brussels, and
DON RAFAEL CERERO, General of Division;
Who, having assembled in Paris, and having exchanged their full powers, which were found to be in due and proper form, have, after discussion of the matters before them, agreed upon the following articles:

ARTICLE I

Spain relinquishes all claim of sovereignty over and title to Cuba.

And as the island is, upon its evacuation by Spain, to be occupied by the United States, the United States will, so long as such as occupation shall last, assume and discharge the obligations that may under international law result from the fact of its occupation, for the protection of life and property.

ARTICLE II

Spain cedes to the United States the island of Porto Rico and other islands now under Spanish sovereignty in the West Indies, and the island of Guam in the Marianas or Ladrões.

ARTICLE III

Spain cedes to the United States the archipelago known as the Philippine Islands, and comprehending the islands lying within the following line:

A line running from west to east along or near the twentieth parallel of north latitude, and through the middle of the navigable channel of Bachi, from the one hundred and eighteenth (118th) to the one hundred and twenty seventh (127th) degrees meridian of longitude east of Greenwich, thence along the one hundred and twenty seventh (127th) degree meridian of longitude east of Greenwich to the parallel of four degree and forty five minutes (4°45') north latitude, thence along the parallel of four degrees and forty five minutes (4°45') north latitude to its intersection with the meridian of longitude one hundred and nineteen degrees and thirty five minutes (119°35') east of Greenwich, thence along the meridian of longitude one hundred and nineteen degrees and thirty five minutes (119°35') east of Greenwich to the parallel of latitude seven degrees and forty minutes (7°40') north, thence along the parallel of latitude seven degrees

155

and forty minutes (7°40') north to its intersection with the one hundred and sixteenth (116th) degree meridian of longitude east of Greenwich, thence by a direct line to the intersection of the tenth (10th) degree parallel of north latitude with the one hundred and eighteenth (118th) degree meridian of longitude east of Greenwich, and thence along the one hundred and eighteenth (118th) degree meridian of longitude east of Greenwich to the point of beginning.

The United States will pay to Spain the sum of twenty million dollars (\$20,000,000) within three months after the exchange of the ratifications of the present treaty.

ARTICLE IV

The United States will, for the term of ten years from the date of the exchange of the ratifications of the present treaty, admit Spanish ships and merchandise to the ports of the Philippine Islands on the same terms as ships and merchandise of the United States.

ARTICLE V

The United States will, upon the signature of the present treaty, send back to Spain, at its own cost, the Spanish soldiers taken as prisoners of war on the capture of Manila by the American forces. The arms of the soldiers in question shall be restored to them.

Spain will, upon the exchange of the ratifications of the present treaty, proceed to evacuate the Philippines, as well as the island of Guam, on terms similar to those agreed upon by the Commissioners appointed to arrange for the evacuation of Porto Rico and other islands in the West Indies, under the Protocol of August 12, 1898, which is to continue in force till its provisions are completely executed.

The time within which the evacuation of the Philippine Islands and Guam shall be completed shall be fixed by the two Governments. Stands of colors, uncaptured war vessels, small arms, guns of all calibres, with their carriages and accessories, powder, ammunition, live stock, and

materials and supplies of all kinds, belonging to the land and naval forces of Spain in the Philippines and Guam, remain the property of Spain. Pieces of heavy ordnance, exclusive of field artillery, in the fortifications and coast defenses, shall remain in their emplacements for the term of six months, to be reckoned from the exchange of ratifications of the treaty; and the United States may, in the mean time, purchase such materials from Spain, if a satisfactory agreement between the two Governments on the subject shall be reached.

ARTICLE VI

Spain will, upon the signature of the present treaty, release all prisoners of war, and all persons detained or imprisoned for political offenses, in connection with the insurrections in Cuba and the Philippines and the war with the United States.

Reciprocally, the United States will release all persons made prisoners of war by the American forces, and will undertake to obtain the release of all Spanish prisoners in the hands of the insurgents in Cuba and the Philippines.

The Government of the United States will at its own cost return to Spain and the Government of Spain will at its own cost return to the United States, Cuba, Porto Rico, and the Philippines,

156

according to the situation of their respective homes, prisoners released or caused to be released by them, respectively, under this article.

ARTICLE VII

The United States and Spain mutually relinquish all claims for indemnity, national and individual, of every kind, of either Government, or of its citizens or subjects, against the other Government that may have arisen since the beginning of the late insurrection in Cuba and prior to the exchange of ratifications of the present treaty, including all claims for indemnity for the cost of the war.

The United States will adjudicate and settle the claims of its citizens against Spain relinquished in this article.

ARTICLE VIII

In conformity with the provisions of Articles I, II, and III of this treaty, Spain relinquishes in Cuba, and cedes in Porto Rico and other islands in the West Indies, in the island of Guam, and in the Philippine Archipelago, all the buildings, wharves, barracks, forts, structures, public highways and other immovable property which, in conformity with law, belong to the public domain, and as such belong to the Crown of Spain.

And it is hereby declared that the relinquishment or cession, as the case may be, to which the preceding paragraph refers, cannot in any respect impair the property or rights which by law belong to the peaceful possession of property of all kinds, of provinces, municipalities, public or private establishments, ecclesiastical or civic bodies, or any other associations having legal capacity to acquire and possess property in the aforesaid territories renounced or ceded, or of private individuals, of whatsoever nationality such individuals may be.

The aforesaid relinquishment or cession, as the case may be, includes all documents exclusively referring to the sovereignty relinquished or ceded that may exist in the archives of the Peninsula. Where any document in such archives only in part relates to said sovereignty, a copy of such part will be furnished whenever it shall be requested. Like rules shall be reciprocally observed in favor of Spain in respect of documents in the archives of the islands above referred to.

In the aforesaid relinquishment or cession, as the case may be, are also included such rights as the Crown of Spain and its authorities possess in respect of the official archives and records, executive as well as judicial, in the island above referred to, which relate to said islands or the rights and property of their inhabitants. Such archives and records shall be carefully preserved, and private persons shall without distinction have the right to require, in accordance with law, authenticated copies of the contracts, wills and other instruments forming part of notarial protocols or files, or which may be contained in the executive or judicial archives, be the latter in Spain or in the islands aforesaid.

ARTICLE IX

157

Spanish subjects, natives of the Peninsula, residing in the territory over which Spain by the present treaty relinquishes or cedes her sovereignty, may remain in such territory or may remove therefrom, retaining in either event all their rights of property, including the right to sell or dispose of such property or of its proceeds; and they shall also have the right to carry on their industry, commerce and professions, being subject in respect thereof to such laws as are applicable to other foreigners. In case they remain in the territory they may preserve their allegiance to the Crown of Spain by making, before a court of record, within a year from the date of the exchange of ratifications of this treaty, a declaration of their decision to preserve such allegiance; in default of which declaration they shall be held to have renounced it and to have adopted the nationality of the territory in which they may reside.

The civil rights and political status of the native inhabitants of the territories hereby ceded to the United States shall be determined by the Congress.

ARTICLE X

The inhabitants of the territories over which Spain relinquishes or cedes her sovereignty shall be secured in the free exercise of their religion.

ARTICLE XI

The Spaniards residing in the territories over which Spain by this treaty cedes or relinquishes her sovereignty shall be subject in matters civil as well as criminal to the jurisdiction of the courts of the country wherein they reside, pursuant to the ordinary laws governing the same; and they shall have the right to appear before such courts, and to pursue the same course as citizens of the country to which the courts belong.

ARTICLE XII

Judicial proceedings pending at the time of the exchange of ratifications of this treaty in the territories over which Spain relinquishes or cedes her sovereignty shall be determined according to the following rules:

1. Judgments rendered either in civil suits between private individuals, or in criminal matters, before the date mentioned, and with respect to which there is no recourse or rights of review under the Spanish law, shall be deemed to be final, and shall be executed in due form by competent authority in the territory within which such judgments should be carried out.
2. Civil suits between private individuals which may on the date mentioned be undetermined shall be prosecuted to judgment before the court in which they may then be pending or in the court that may be substituted therefor.
3. Criminal actions pending on the date mentioned before the Supreme Court of Spain against citizens of the territory which by this treaty ceases to be Spanish shall continue under its jurisdiction until final judgment; but, such judgment having been rendered, the execution thereof shall be committed to the competent authority of the place in which the case arose.

158

ARTICLE XIII

The rights of property secured by copyrights and patents acquired by Spaniards in the Island of Cuba, and in Porto Rico, the Philippines and other ceded territories, at the time of the exchange of the ratifications of this treaty, shall continue to be respected. Spanish scientific, literary and artistic works, not subversive of public order in the territories in question, shall continue to be admitted free of duty into such territories, for the period of ten years, to be reckoned from the date of the exchange of the ratifications of this treaty.

ARTICLE XIV

Spain shall have the power to establish consular officers in the ports and places of the territories, the sovereignty over which has been either relinquished or ceded by the present treaty.

ARTICLE XV

The Government of each country will, for the term of ten years, accord to the merchant vessels of the other country the same treatment in respect of all port charges, including entrance and clearance dues, light dues, and tonnage duties, as it accords to its own merchant vessels, not engaged in the coastwise trade.

This article may at any time be terminated on six months' notice given by either Government to the other.

ARTICLE XVI

It is understood that any obligations assumed in this treaty by the United States with respect to Cuba are limited to the time of its occupancy thereof; but it will upon the termination of such occupancy, advise any Government established in the island to assume the same obligations.

ARTICLE XVII

The present treaty shall be ratified by the President of the United States, by and with the advice and consent of the Senate thereof, and by Her Majesty the Queen Regent of Spain; and the ratifications shall be exchanged at Washington within six months from the date hereof, or earlier if possible.

In faith whereof, we, the respective Plenipotentiaries, have signed this treaty and have hereunto affixed our seals.

Done in duplicate at Paris, the tenth day of December, in the year of Our Lord one thousand eight hundred and ninety-eight.

WILLIAM R. DAY
CUSHMAN K. DAVIS
WM P. FRYE
GEO. GRAY
WHITELAW REID.

159

EUGENIO MONTERO RIOS
B. DEABARDUZA
J. DE GARNICA
W R DE VILLA URRUTIA
RAFAEL CERERO

And whereas, the said Convention has been duly ratified on both parts, and the ratifications of the two Governments were exchanged in the City of Washington, on the eleventh day of April, one thousand eight hundred and ninety-nine;

Now, therefore, be it known that I, William McKinley, President of the United States of America, have caused the said Convention to be made public, to the end that the same and every article and clause thereof may be observed and fulfilled with good faith by the United States and the citizens thereof.

In witness whereof, I have hereunto set my hand and caused the seal of the United States to be affixed.

Done at the City of Washington, this eleventh day of April, in the year of Our Lord one thousand eight hundred and ninety-nine, and of the Independence of the United States the one hundred and twenty-third.

Signed: William McKinley

160

President William McKinley's Prayer

ANNOTATION

The section is an excerpt written by Homer C. Stuntz who was the pioneering missionary of the Board of Missions of the Methodist Church. His close friendship with Governor Howard Taft allowed him to write about the Philippines where he stayed for two years. This piece of information stemmed from the fact that President McKinley was a devout Methodist Christian and he shared his thoughts with a group of American Methodist dignitaries who visited him at the White House on November 21, 1899. The significance of this excerpt is that it gives an insider's view of how President McKinley arrived at his decision to issue his famous "Benevolent Assimilation" Policy. Citing that it was God's will that the US should annex the Philippine Islands after praying hard supported the idea that occupying the Philippine islands had a blessing from God and should be seen from the vantage point of the Christian zeal of missionary work by way of spreading the good news to the natives of the archipelago. This "divine revelation" would eventually shape the annexation of the Philippine islands to implement America's imperialist aspirations.

Meantime the question of what to do with the Philippines was the one which perplexed our authorities in Washington. President McKinley faced it, and sought advice from all parties. Perhaps the fullest unofficial statement he ever made of the way his own conclusion to hold the Islands was reached is contained in his address to a committee of clergymen, as reported in the *Christian Advocate* by General James. F. Rusling. General Rusling was a member of a committee from a religious gathering in Washington to present resolutions of thanks to President McKinley for courtesies shown its members, and, with Bishop Thomas Bowman, Bishop John F. Hurst, and Drs. Upham and Buckley, met with the President by appointment in his private office in the White House for that purpose, November 21, 1899. After a pleasant interview the members of the committee rose to take their leave. The President detained them to give the following statement:

"Before you go I would like to say just a word about the Philippine business. I have been criticized a good deal about the Philippines, but don't deserve it. The truth is, I didn't want the Philippines, and when they came to us, as a gift from the gods, I did not know what to do with them. When the Spanish War broke out, Dewey was at Hong-Kong, and I ordered him to go to Manila, and he had to; because, if defeated, he had no place to refit on that side of the globe, and if the Dons were victorious they would likely cross the Pacific and ravage our Oregon and California coasts. And so he had to destroy the Spanish fleet, and did it! But that was as far as I thought then.

"When I next realized that the Philippines had dropped into our lap, I confess I did not know what to do with them. I sought counsel from all sides – Democrats as well as Republicans – but got little help. I thought first we would take only Manila; then Luzon; then other islands, perhaps, also. I walked the floor of the White house night after night until midnight; and I am not ashamed to tell you, gentlemen, that I went down on my knees and prayed Almighty God for

light and guidance more than one night. And one night late it came to me this way – I don't know

161

hot it was, but it came: (1) That we could not give them back to Spain—that would be cowardly and dishonorable; (2) That we could not turn them over to France or Germany—our commercial rivals in the Orient—that would be bad business and discreditable; (3) That we could not leave them to themselves—they were unfit for self-government—and they would soon have anarchy and misrule over there worse than Spain's was; and (4) That there was nothing left for us to do but to take them all, and to educate the Filipinos, and uplift and civilize and Christianize them, and, by God's grace, do the very best we could by them, as our fellow-men for whom Christ also died. And then I went to bed, and went to sleep, and slept soundly, and the next morning I sent for the chief engineer of the War Department (our map-maker), and told him to put the Philippines on the map of the United States (pointing to a large map on the wall of his office); and there they are, and there they will stay while I am President!"

The American occupation of the Philippines was undertaken with motives as humane and disinterested as those which drove us to war with Spain at first. The fact is, that the hour of destiny had struck. The forbearance of a just God was exhausted. Spain must dispossessed of territories which she had ruled with force and cruelty. A new order must begin.

162

Benevolent Assimilation Policy Declaration

EXECUTIVE MANSION, WASHINGTON, December 21, 1898.

ANNOTATION

On Dec. 21, 1898, President McKinley issued the BENEVOLENT ASSIMILATION PROCLAMATION, announced in the Philippines on Jan. 4, 1899, which stated the U.S.' "humane" mission in acquiring the Philippines. He emphasized that the U.S. have "come, not as invaders or conquerors, but as friends, to protect the natives in their homes, in their employment, and their personal and religious rights." He proclaimed after the signing of the Treaty of Paris, asserting that the "military government maintained in Manila is to be extended to the whole Philippine islands and that the United States government assumes full control and sovereignty of the Spanish government over the Philippines. After a lengthy debate, the U.S congress ratified the treaty on February 6, 1899.

Moreover, the U.S. wanted to "win the confidence, respect, and affection of the inhabitants of the Philippines by assuring them in every possible way that full measure of individual rights and liberties which is the heritage of free peoples, and by proving to them that the mission of the United States is one of benevolent assimilation substituting the mild sway of justice and right for arbitrary rule." From the proclamation itself, President McKinley had denied the very concept of the declaration of war against Spain by deciding to annex the Philippines.

The destruction of the Spanish fleet in the harbor of Manila by the United States naval squadron commanded by Rear-Admiral Dewey, followed by the reduction of the city and the surrender of the Spanish forces, practically effected the conquest of the Philippine Islands and the suspension of the Spanish sovereignty therein. With the signature of the treaty of peace between the United States and Spain by their respective plenipotentiaries at Paris on the 10th instant, and as a result of the victories of American arms, *the future control, disposition, and government of the Philippine Islands are ceded to the United States*. In the fulfillment of the *rights of sovereignty* thus acquired and the responsible obligations of government thus assumed, the actual occupation and administration of the entire group of the Philippine Islands becomes immediately necessary, and the *military government* heretofore maintained by the United States in the city, harbor, and bay of Manila *is to be extended with all possible dispatch to the whole of the ceded territory*.

In performing this duty the military commander of the United States is enjoined to make known to the inhabitants of the Philippine Islands that in *succeeding to the sovereignty of Spain*, in severing the former political relations, and in establishing a new political power, the authority of the United States is to be exerted for the securing of the persons and property of the people of the islands and for the confirmation of all their private rights and relations. It will be the duty of the commander of the forces of occupation to announce and proclaim in the most public manner that *we come*, not as invaders or

163

conquerors, but as friends, *to protect* the natives in their homes, in their employments, and in their personal and religious rights. All persons who, either by active aid or by honest submission, co-operate with the Government of the United States to give effect to these beneficent purposes will receive the reward of its support and *protection*. All others will be brought within the lawful rule we have assumed, with firmness if need be, but without severity, so far as possible. Within the absolute domain of *military authority*, which necessarily is and *must remain supreme* in the ceded territory until the legislation of the United States shall otherwise provide, the municipal laws of the territory in respect to private rights and property and the repression of crime are to be considered as continuing in force, and to be administered by the ordinary tribunals, so far as practicable. The operations of civil and municipal government are to be performed by such officers as may accept *the supremacy of the United States* by taking the oath of allegiance, or by officers chosen, as far as practicable, from the inhabitants of the islands. While the control of all the public property and the revenues of the state passes with the cession, and while the use and management of all public means of transportation are necessarily reserved to the authority of the United States, private property, whether belonging to individuals or corporations, is to be respected except for cause duly established. The taxes and duties heretofore payable by the inhabitants to the late government become payable to the authorities of the United

States unless it be seen fit to substitute for them other reasonable rates or modes of contribution to the expenses of government, whether general or local. If private property be taken for military use, it shall be paid for when possible in cash, at a fair valuation, and when payment in cash is not practicable, receipts are to be given. All ports and places in the Philippine Islands in the actual possession of the land and naval forces of the United States will be opened to the commerce of all friendly nations. All goods and wares not prohibited for military reasons by due announcement of the military authority will be admitted upon payment of such duties and other charges as shall be in force at the time of their importation. Finally, it should be the earnest wish and paramount aim of the military administration to win the confidence, respect, and affection of the inhabitants of the Philippines by assuring them in every possible way that full measure of individual rights and liberties which is the heritage of free peoples, and by proving to them that the mission of the United States is one of

BENEVOLENT ASSIMILATION

substituting the mild sway of justice and right for arbitrary rule. In the fulfillment of this high mission, supporting the temperate administration of affairs for the greatest good of the governed, there must be sedulously maintained the strong arm of authority, to repress disturbance and to overcome all obstacles to the bestowal of the blessings of good and stable government upon the people of the Philippine Islands under the free flag of the United States.

WILLIAM McKINLEY.

164

Excerpt from Palma, R., Kalaw, T. M. (Teodoro Manguiat). (1923). Our campaign for independence from Taft to Harrison (1901-1921). Manila: Bureau of printing. pp 15 to 17

ANNOTATION

Rafael Palma was a member of the Philippine Commission and was later elected Senator and ultimately appointed as the fourth President of the University of the Philippines. Teodoro M. Kalaw was a nationalist scholar, legislator, journalist, educator, and historian. The two authors were very active as political leaders and officials of the government during the American period. This excerpt provides an authoritative account of the evolution of the two dominant parties during the American period. It provides clear insights and details on why the respective political parties were organized including the discussion of their political platforms.

It was the inauguration of the First Philippine Assembly in 1907 that paved the way for the country's independence from American rule as it provided the Filipino legislators to have hands-on experience in the local political affairs. This event was very significant in the history of Philippine politics since this event also witnessed the first national election in our country through popular votes. The Filipinos' aspirations for greater political participation and their thirst for self-rule were realized in the establishment of the Philippine legislature. This glorious victory of the Filipinos was accompanied by

enormous responsibilities because they have to prove to the U.S Congress, the international community, and to the Filipino nation that the Filipinos could govern themselves properly and dutifully.

THE FEDERAL PARTY IS ORGANIZED

Since the beginning of the Filipino American War there had been a small group of Filipinos who were opposed to it. These remained in Manila since the commencement of hostilities and did not take part in the risk of the campaign, some of them believing in good faith that it was a mistake and that it was foolish to fight against forces a hundred times superior. From among these Filipinos the Commission recruited its followers and advisers. Later on, some of the politicians who had been followers of Aguinaldo, and had taken refuge in the amnesty proclamation, joined this small nucleus, perhaps because they were convinced that to continue resistance would merely weaken the country materially and economically, and that it was more prudent because of pressure of circumstances, to temporarily renounce the political ideal that they had espoused. With the Filipino troop dispersed and the consequent surrender of many of their generals; with the first acts of the Commission that bore signs of democracy and the desire to count with public opinion in the making of the laws; with the reelection of McKinley that assured the continuance of his policy for another four years, and, lastly, with the proclamation of General McArthur threatening the Filipinos in arms with a series of cruel and severe penalties the group of conservative Filipino saw that the time had come to act, and they organized a political party under the name of Federal Party. The principal object of the

165

party was to hasten general peace in all the provinces and then to establish a territorial government which in time would make possible the admission of the Islands as a State of the North American Union. It was with unfeigned satisfaction that the Commission welcomed the organization of this party. It was not only a clear proof that their reassuring reports to Washington were founded on fact; it made it easier for them besides to carry out their plan of retaining the Islands indefinitely. The possibility of making the Islands a state of the American union was a handy pretext with which to drive away the idea of independence so deeply imbedded in the minds of the Filipinos. It was for this reason that the Commission lent most cordial and decided support to the Federal Party and its dignitaries, and it placed at their disposal all the facilities and means available under a state of actual war with which to carry out their propaganda ends. In the Commission's phraseology, the Federal Party spread thru out the Islands with lightning like rapidity; but it spread not on account of the principles it stood for, but rather because of the spoils and benefits that it might be able to divide among those enlisting in its ranks. The hardships of the military rule under which many families were groaning, coupled with the enticing offers of honors and recompense from the government coffers, was the magnificent combination that had the effect of greatly weakening the resistance of the most valiant exponents of independence. The Federal Party was victorious all along the lines and rightly could it boast at the time of its easy conquests. It had with it the cream and the flower of plutocracy and the

country's aristocracy of talent, at the same time that it enjoyed unlimited power, confidence, and influence in the councils of the new government.

Without losing time, the Commission organized the municipal governments, and soon afterwards the provincial governments. This furnished the occasion for a triumphal trip of the Commission from one province to another, familiarizing themselves with men and things, mixing socially with the Filipinos, informing them of the Commission's benevolent mission and promising them, like kindly guardians, a greater degree of popular government if they would conduct themselves as became good wards. 6

The lesson, however, was not mastered so easily by such provinces as Cavite, Batangas, Cebu, and Samar where the civil governments had to be turned over to the military; but on the whole it can be said that the rest of the provinces behaved in the manner expected of them. Hence it was that the Commission, complying with its mission of peace, organized the central civil government on July 4, 1901, in spite of the intrigues of the military who would not relinquish hold of the government so easily in favor of others.

Page 19 to 23

THE NATIONALISTS APPEAR ON THE SCENE

166

About the time, when Taft was absent in Rome, the Nationalists, who had until then kept silent but had been observing with grief the course that events had taken, began to feel the first qualms of conscience and they decided to take soundings to see whether the stream could be forded. A number of "consistents," as they styled themselves, met, deliberated, and drew up, without delay, a program containing the following bases:

ESSENTIAL BASE

First'— The securing of the independence of the Islands thru lawful means.

INCIDENTAL BASES

Second. Modification of the present administration of the Philippines so as to give the Filipinos a greater degree of self government, as an announcement of the capacity of the Filipino people.

Third. —Modification of article seven of the Philippine Bill as follows: (a) Immediate establishment of two legislative chamber upon the completion of the Census.

(b) Both these legislative chambers to be elected by popular suffrage, to safeguard the interests of the Filipino people, and to be patterned after the two Houses of Congress in America.

(c) The bills passed by the Philippine Legislature to become laws subject to the same rules set forth in the American Constitution.

Fourth. —Admission of Philippine products into the United States customs free. Fifth .

Protective legislation for the Philippine industries. A committee of three was appointed to lay this program before Governor Wright, who was acting in the absence of Mr. Taft. It is said that

Governor Wright, upon learning the purpose of the committee, knitted his brow in displeasure and flatly refused to give his assent to the program. Although aggrieved by Governor Wright's reception, the Nacionalistas were not discouraged, and when Mr. Taft arrived they named another committee to see him. Mr. Taft was more diplomatic as to form than Mr. Wright, but was just as unyielding as to substance.

In his opinion, the propaganda of the Nacionalista party would stir up the fires of the insurrection anew and would kill the party itself. It would be impossible to prevent the authorities from suspecting the Nationalists from within and confusing them with the brigands out in the field. Along similar lines, Mr. Taft addressed the committee. He took care to suggest, however, that if the word "independence" were eliminated from the program, he would have no objection to recognizing the new party. Debates and doubts ensued among the organizers of the party, but in the end the opinion prevailed that the grapes were still green and must be allowed to ripen; they, therefore, retreated to their original position of watchful waiting. It was

167

impossible, however, for the Federalists' error to continue blindfolding the country for any length of time. The Saint Louis Exposition of 1904 which induced many Filipinos to visit the United States, gave the Federal Party a lesson which it would not even admit when Mabini made them see the impossibility of their platform.

There was not a single American who seriously favored the annexation of the Philippines. To them, such annexation was precluded by the distance of the Islands and by the customs of the Filipinos that were totally different. Many of the prominent "Federalists" who had gone to the United States in the honest belief that their platform had some merit to it, came back confused and disheartened. The panacea they had administered on the country was a fatal one, and could not cure it, so that the party found itself in a very embarrassing position which not even the changes, subsequently adopted, were able to remedy.

The Nacionalistas took advantage of the opportunity and came out in the open. The state of war that had silenced them there tofore and prevented the carrying out of any propaganda for the party, had ceased to exist. There was nothing in the organic law prohibiting their working in a peaceful manner for the independence of the country. The Census had been completed and two years later the elections for the first Philippine Assembly was to be held. Herein we have to do justice to the American people. The liberal spirit of their Constitution which allows no barriers to free thought and its free expression, had made it possible for the Filipinos to campaign peacefully for their independence and to provide the ways and means necessary to obtain it. No other people has permitted a similar liberty to the inhabitants of a territory under its sway. Thus it was that the Nacionalistas, in organizing their party, never lost sight of, nor have they ever failed to recognize, this generosity on the part of the American people and their representatives in the Islands. Thus it was also that the leaders of the Nacionalistas never have shown an attitude of arrogance or of challenge even in the most trying situations, but instead they have placed

themselves in the position of one merely complying with a duty dictated by the voice of the people. They considered themselves as trustees of the ideals of the Revolution, who were in duty bound to continue the works of those who had fallen.

In all their campaigns they limited themselves to showing to the American people and their representatives here that the cause of independence had not ceased to have followers in the country, and that, in spite of the personal liberties granted the Filipinos and the participation given them in the different branches of the government, they still cherished the ambition to have their own nationality and their own government under their own laws. In no manner were they impeded by the Government in their organization, but while there were no impediments from that end, there were many when the time arrived for the heads of the organization to come to an understanding. Because of this lack of understanding the Nacionalistas

168

became divided into various groups, the dividing line between each of which they themselves were unable to delineate. They lost much time discussing the clauses and planks of their respective platforms, until, on the eve of the election, the apprehension of a common disaster made them reunite, but only temporarily, because after their victory at the polls they fell to disputing again among themselves.

169

**Excerpt from Harrison, Francis Burton. *The Corner-Stone of Philippine Independence*.
New York: The Century Co., 1922. pp 60 – 74**

ANNOTATION

Francis Burton Harrison (1873-1957) was a lawyer educated at Yale and the New York Law School. As a Democrat representing the State of New York, he was a U.S. congressman from 1903 to 1905 and from 1907 to 1912, and in 1916 President Woodrow Wilson appointed him Governor-General of the Philippines. As a fervent anti-imperialist and opponent of "Dollar Diplomacy," Harrison speeded up the filipinization of civil service posts, introduced reforms toward self-government, and espoused the Democrat program to give early independence to the Philippines. The Democrats lost in the elections of 1920, but Harrison returned to Manila in 1935 to serve as a presidential adviser to President Manuel L. Quezon under the Philippine Commonwealth. He was also an adviser to the Philippine government-in-exile during World War II, as well as to Presidents Manuel Roxas, Elpidio Quirino, and Ramon Magsaysay. At his request, Harrison was buried in the Philippines.

The excerpt depicts the personal view of Harrison on the Filipino leaders and politicians who were emerging as the new leaders of the government. His descriptions of his relationships with the leaders and their ways offer a firsthand version of the evolution of the political control and influence of members of the Philippine Assembly. This selection also shows his thoughts on the role and challenges he faced as the Governor-General of the Philippines.

CHAPTER V

Filipinos in Control of Legislature

It is not my intention to write here a history of the Philippine Government during the past eight years. As a participant in the work of that administration I could not, in all probability, write impartially of it. The records are all there, and it is too soon to pronounce final judgment. Those of us who have been connected with the administration have many times given public expression to our purposes and public record to our explanations. Most of it is already embalmed in the mortuary of government reports on file in Washington and Manila.

Some Filipino historian in the years to come will probably, from the angle of vision afforded those who come after us, go through the musty records of the past, and give to this period a few chapters in a history of the Philippines. My hope is that in this volume I may contribute something of interest to the world-wide discussion concerning the capacity of the tropical races for self-government, as observed by one who has been engaged in giving to the Filipinos the fullest possible opportunity to demonstrate such capacity. If for this purpose government records and statistics are quoted, it will be in the endeavor to show to what an extent the Philippines have developed politically, economically, and otherwise materially, under their own government. (60)

170

It is impossible, however, to avoid frequent reference to the governor-general and his relation to the general situation ; his position is by tradition the very nerve-center of Philippine administration, and he is given by law very full powers of supervision and control. It was one of my purposes to assign gradually to the proper functionaries the responsibilities which should be theirs. The Governor-General of the Philippines receives a salary of \$18,000 a year from the Insular Treasury, and the residence known as Malacañang Palace in Manila is set aside for his use. The salary had been \$21,000, but was reduced, at my insistence and against the wishes of members of the Legislature, during my first weeks of office, when for reasons of vitally necessary economy other salaries were being cut. The salaries of the Governor of Hong-Kong and the Governor-General of Java are about three times as high ; of the Governor General of British India about four or five times as much. It costs the Governor-General of the Philippines from twice to four times his salary to live in Malacañang, according to his disposition in the matters of entertaining and general style of living. No motor-car is furnished him, and no servants, but he has free light and water and a cottage allowed him in the mountains in Baguio, known as the Mansion House. Free music is provided for entertainments in Manila, furnished by the Constabulary Band. Before leaving I was instrumental in arranging that the appropriation bill should provide for the "entertainment of distinguished guests" out of the \$100,000 appropriated in the General Purpose funds, when "approved by the Council of State."

This should lighten the financial (61)

burden of my successor. It was made use of once in my last few months of office to the amount of about \$3000, to pay for the extraordinary expenditures necessary for entertainment at Malacañang of the visitors who were members of the Congressional party. Malacañang Palace is one of the most comfortable and delightful homes in the tropics. The Spaniards were the best of all the European races as builders in the hot countries, perhaps because they learned how to build in their own. The English make themselves miserable in the tropics by reproducing in every respect possible the houses and methods of life of their own cold climate. Malacañang was originally purchased by the Spanish Government about a century ago as a casita or country house, and has been added to from time to time until it has now a huge floor space of old hand-hewn hardwood, and is admirably fitted for large entertainments. The balcony projects over the swiftly flowing Pasig River, and there is generally a pleasant breeze there, even during the hottest weather. The thermometer in my room generally stood at 83°, and seldom went below 76° or above 89°. The gardens along the river are noted for the fairy-land illumination displayed at evening entertainments. Malacañang has been greatly enlarged and modernized in the last few years, and a beautiful new executive office building in the garden has just been completed. In the disastrous earthquake of 1865 the big stone palace of the governor-general, on what is now Plaza McKinley, was totally destroyed, and the governor-general moved temporarily into Malacañang; like so much else that the Spanish intended as temporary, it has become his permanent residence. When I settled (62) in Malacañang I was the ninety-fifth governor-general, and served in that position for seven and a half years, or longer than any one of the forty-four who had directly preceded me, dating back to the eighteenth century. The governor-general has an office in Malacañang, but when he was also President of the Philippine Commission, which

171

sat daily during the Legislative sessions, it was customary for him to go to the Ayuntamiento, or City Hall, every day for his office work.

It was frequently charged that in my first months of office I would not consult with "the Americans"; so far as I am aware, I saw all Americans who wished to advise with me,—indeed, gave hours to that service, day after day, year after year. The real difficulty was that I did not always take the advice, not of "the Americans," but of certain Americans who had composed what had been popularly known as the "kitchen cabinet," or "polo cabinet" of recent years.

Few of them held official positions, and many of them seemed to me to be inspired by private financial interests rather than the public interest. Anyone who has ever held public executive office will know how very great a part of his time is occupied in seeing people and receiving advice. This is particularly so in the Philippines, where for ages a paternal government had been conducted, with the governor-general, whether by law or custom, the head and center of it all. Week after week my time was occupied with receiving complaints, advice, or requests, often from the same people again and again. Finally I came to feel that my office was not unlike that of a medical man : persons came to me only when in trouble, and for consultation and relief. (63)

At the very beginning I made of record the fact that I had come to govern the islands in consultation also with the Filipinos. I was thus brought into immediate and daily contact with

Mr. Sergio Osmena, the Speaker of the House of Representatives, president of the Nacionalista party and the leading representative of the Filipino people. This remarkable man had already been Speaker for five years, and still holds that office. I found him extremely well informed, not only about Philippine affairs, but about American history and Constitutional law. Wise, astute, and cautious, of an impressive personality, he was also possessed of most remarkable courteous good manners, which never failed him. For the past thirteen years he and Mr. Quezon have been the dominant personalities in Philippine politics. I have never heard either of them speak a word of criticism or ill-will against the United States or the American people, and only very rarely against an individual American. They have always had a faith in our country and an appreciation of what our country has done for their people far above the petty level of political and racial feelings in Manila.

Our first duty was to select for recommendation to the President the names of the new Filipino majority in the commission which was promised by his message. Mr. Osmena furnished a list of a dozen names, and we proposed to submit them for approval to the Philippine Assembly, so that all the elected representatives of the people might have a share in the selection, but this plan was vetoed by the Secretary of War. I then consulted Chief Justice Arellano, Resident Commissioners Quezon and Earnshaw, and Colonel Harbord, (65)

Chief of Constabulary. The five names agreed upon were cabled to the Secretary of War, and the commissioners were shortly nominated by the President and confirmed by the Senate, as follows: Victorino Mapa of Iloilo as Secretary of Finance and Justice; Rafael Palma of Manila, for several years already a member of the commission, for reappointment; Vicente Ilustre of

172

Batangas ; Jaime de Veyra of Leyte and Vicente Singson-Encarnacion of Ilocos Sur. Palma and De Veyra were members of the Nacionalista party, Mapa sympathetically inclined to that party, Ilustre an independent, and Singson the leader of the Progresista party in the House of Representatives. For nearly three years, until the change of government under the Jones Act, we worked. Together through seasons of political excitement and turmoil with perfect harmony and mutual good-will. It may serve to illustrate the types of older Filipino leaders to describe these commissioners here.

Secretary Mapa, who sat for twelve years upon the Philippine Supreme Court bench, is short of stature and dignified in demeanor. He served in Spanish days as Alcalde (or Mayor) of the City of Iloilo. His courtesy and modesty are so great that none but his intimate friends know his rare sense of humor and fund of anecdotes and proverbs. Some of his best stories are of playing tresillo (cards) with Governor-General Weyler, who was a short man like himself, with a terrific military reputation and menacing gestures; Mr. Mapa incidentally points out that General Weyler in all his long life had never once been under fire himself. As a member of the commission, Mr. Mapa's services were invaluable; nobody in the islands has a better (66)

legal mind, and he was constantly appealed to by his colleagues for his opinion on all legal points, never offering his advice in general discussions until it was asked. He was generous and

kindly always, but in a parliamentary fight, once he had made up his mind, he was absolutely fearless, a veritable little Lion of Justice. His face is like an engraving of a French statesman of the seventeenth century, and his sense of honor and fair play are above all party or political considerations. He was recently made Chief Justice of the Supreme Court, to succeed the late Chief Justice Cavetona Arellano, but had to resign his position before a year of incumbency, on account of ill-health.

Rafael Palma is generally considered the third man in Filipino politics. His somewhat severe and melancholy face frequently lights up with an unexpected and sunny smile, as his sense of humor is pronounced. He has a good legal mind, rare literary ability, and a talent for public speaking ; and he speaks in the choicest Spanish. He is modest and industrious, and a loyal party man, upon whom a large part of the burden of party management was placed by Speaker Osmena. His service in the House of Representatives, the commission, the Philippine Senate, and on the Board of Regents of the University of the Philippines has been marked by absolute integrity and by a devotion to the cause of public instruction. As Secretary of the Interior he handled successfully many of the most delicate problems of the Government. Just and fair, he is popular with Americans and Filipinos alike. Being a very poor man, he has recently retired from the cabinet to enter business, as he has, in the Filipino fashion, a large and growing family. (67)

Jaime de Veyra was governor of the great province of Leyte during the troublesome days of the uprising of the pulajans, or outlaws, about fifteen years ago. His literary ability is marked, and illuminates his reports and papers, as he served an apprenticeship as a newspaper editor. He has held office in the House of Representatives and the commission and as Secretary of Commerce and Police, and then as Executive Secretary of the Government. His charming wife is a great

173

asset to him, with her facility for making and keeping friends among the American Congressional ladies, since Don Jaime is now one of the two Representatives in Congress from the Philippines. He is of a thick-set figure, somewhat darker than his colleagues, and of a very serious turn of mind, rarely smiling or talking except when he has something to say, when he develops a rather unexpected eloquence. He is extremely tender-hearted and inclined to sentiment. Vicente Illustre has dark and handsome features, and is possessed of much dignity and grace of manner. He served as a member of the Revolutionary Junta in Hong-Kong during the insurrection, and since then has practised law and watched over his sugar plantations in Batangas. He came from private life to the commission, where he did arduous and valuable work in drafting the laws for the reformation of the Justice of the Peace service, and also the new code for the government of the Department of Mindanao and Sulu, in 1914. He, like Mr. Mapa and Mr. Singson, has considerable wealth, and lives in a luxurious home surrounded with all comforts and with works of art. Mr. Illustre was always something of an insurrecto in politics, and though he gained a seat for the short term in the Sen- (67)

ate, in 1916, he was ousted by his opponent in 1918 and has since practised law. He is rather more suspicious of the intentions of the United States than are his colleagues, and is aggressively

in favor of the immediate independence of his country. His education was completed in Madrid in the later days of Spanish domination, and he has imbibed there some of the old-world cynicism as to the promises and agreements of nations. Vicente Singson is a tall, slow moving figure of the mestizo type. He is an able public speaker, and has served in the House of Representatives, the commission, and the Senate. He is a Conservative and his interests are largely those of business and finance. Humor seldom disturbs his dignity, but his manners are affability and courtesy personified. His talents are those of the world of commerce, rather than of legislative halls, but he is ready and able to advance his views and defend his opinions on all occasions. His presence strengthened the business side of the commission.

Like Mr. Palma, he has been to the United States twice, and seems to like American customs and ideas. I find on reading over these descriptive sketches of my first Filipino colleagues that I have stressed the dignity of them all ; they are all of the older type and generation, and of them only Mr. Palma speaks English readily ; none have had an American public-school education. Dignity of demeanor is essentially an Oriental characteristic,—dignity with an impassive tinge. In the expression of most of the older Filipinos there is a trace of melancholy, as there is in all the Filipino music of older days,—the mark of centuries of service as a subject race. Men of the younger generation, already coming upon the stage in business and public affairs, look full of hope, ambition, and American hustle. Upon first acquaintance, Americans are not aware of the sense of fun of the Filipinos; their solemnity is an affair of manner rather than of mind. I remember several meetings of the all-Filipino Council of State in which the bursts of laughter must have disconcerted the officials on the other side of the swing doors. Loyal friends, good companions, dependable advisers—I regret leaving them all In public affairs I found them ever conscientious and patriotic, with a fine sense of the respect owed the United States Government, and a due

174

consciousness of obligation to their own people. Never was an anti-American measure introduced intentionally. They realized that the Filipinos were on trial, and that they themselves were the representatives of their fellow countrymen before the world. Hardly a possible problem of government but came before the commission or the Council of State during these years. I found them in debate, and in the care with which they cast their votes, as full of responsibility and of intelligent understanding as any legislators I have known anywhere.

Those departments of government which they had never possessed before, and which were therefore new to them, were studied with the utmost care and deliberation. In later chapters I shall discuss the development of Filipino governmental abilities. Within a few months the membership of the Philippine Commission was completed by President Wilson, and there arrived from the United States the new American members,—Vice-Governor Henderson S. Martin, a progressive Democrat from Kansas, genial and sunny-tempered, with a decided leaning toward all liberal and democratic ideas; Winfred T. Denison, Secretary of the Interior, sensitive and high-minded, one of the Progressive Republicans from New York, loyally devoted to the principle of Filipino self-government; and Clinton L. Riggs of Baltimore, Secretary of Commerce and Police, a Democrat of the most conservative type, whose bias in favor of the

generally accepted standards of colonial government soon earned for him among the resident Americans the nickname of "the White Hope."

General Riggs was a most charming social companion, and a most difficult colleague in government. He was, from the very beginning, out of sympathy with the new policy in the Philippines, and, I think, came out with the idea of replacing me when my removal was accomplished by the campaign then under way. He was closely in the confidence of the Secretary of War, who also was greatly disturbed at the reports coming from the Philippines; and although Secretary Garrison subsequently became disgusted with the misinformation about the Philippines which was being disseminated through the United States, and in a spirit of generous indignation entered into a sharp controversy with Mr. Taft in the public press in defense of my administration, I am sure he would, himself, say that he never really sympathized with our radical plans in the Philippines; indeed, it will be remembered that his resignation as Secretary of War was based partly upon his dissatisfaction with the speedy preparations for Philippine independence. General Riggs stood firmly upon his interpretation of the law which gave the governor-general only "supervision" of the (70) other department secretaries; he told me that "supervision" gave only an advisory power, and no right of interference in his d e p a r t m e n t , which included the Philippine Constabulary, of which by law the governor-general was commander-in-chief. The Jones Act of 1916 cleared up this controversy by giving the governor general "supervision and control" over all departments of government. During the eighteen months of our controversy, General Riggs and I, after the fashion of Anglo-Saxons, managed to remain, personally and socially, good friends. He went home ill in the summer of 1915, and his resignation was accepted by the President in December of that year.

Poor Denison was the official who suffered most from the troublesome political storms of those early days; his was a spontaneous, frank, and sincere nature, and he was genuinely inspired with

175

a desire to bring self-government to the Filipinos. He was not of the stern stuff necessary to face public criticism and abuse. Within his first few months he made a speech at the City Club in Manila in which he advocated giving the Filipinos their rights, or, as he phrased it, "give them what they want." He at once became the target for a veritable bombardment of ridicule and abuse from the "organization," and his spirit was completely shattered. He left the Philippines a year later, in a most melancholy frame of mind, absolutely broken on the wheel of the "organization's" criticism.

Vice-Governor Martin, of a serene and well-balanced disposition, rode the waves successfully and rendered excellent service in the commission. His chief work was in the public schools, in founding the Rural Credit Association system, and in drafting and forcing (71) through the charter of the Philippine National Bank. He resigned in the autumn of 1916, and I think has since regretted that he did not remain to carry on the work he liked so well. He was a valuable and much valued pillar of support in our Philippine policy. He was succeeded in June, 1917, by Vice-Governor Charles E. Yeater of Missouri, at the present writing acting Governor-General of the Philippines.

To the Filipinos, the majority upon the commission meant that the dead-lock as to appropriations and other important measures would be broken instantaneously, and that in the selection of their higher officials, such as bureau chiefs, and judges of the First Instance, they were to have the controlling vote in the commission, to which, by existing law, such nominations were sent for confirmation. Long-standing grievances which they wished to remove were now in their hands for settlement. Above all, the new policy was a recognition of their political rights and race dignity, for which they showed immediate gratitude.

The morning after the announcement of the new step forward, "La Vanguardia," the leading Filipino paper, theretofore a very resolute opponent of American policies in the islands, expressed in Spanish the general sentiment editorially under the heading

"Dawn of the New Era" as follows:

Magical Effect of President's Grave and Dignified Message . . .

Complete Disappearance of All Hitherto Existing Prejudices and a Great Improvement in Political Atmosphere.

Much has already been said and written in regard to the necessity of a better understanding, of harmony and cooperation, but, hitherto, results have been always negative and all (72)efforts seemed fruitless. Matters went from bad to worse. Now, however, it has been sufficient for the chosen representative of President Wilson to make a simple and frank statement of policy, and the situation as a result is completely changed. These statements have been sufficient to revive in a most admirable and complete manner the faith of Filipinos in the justice of the American people, and all prejudices and misunderstandings that have grown up in the past have

176

been immediately wiped away. As a result, it can be said that since the decided views of the Democratic Administration have been announced never before in our mutual history have respect and consideration of American sovereignty been as firmly rooted in these islands as it is now.

The editor of the "Vanguardia," Mr. Alejandro Roces, the most influential and independent daily publisher in the islands, maintained the same attitude unswervingly during my whole administration. His unselfish patriotism and determined freedom from any official connections lent weight to his opinions.

Upon the day after the delivery of the first message to the Legislature—October 16, 1913—the Philippine Assembly gave official expression to similar views in a resolution, reciting the firm stand of the Filipino people for immediate independence from the day of the insurrection against Spain in 1896, through all trials and vicissitudes, and their patient confidence that ultimately the United States Government would redress "all errors and injustices." T h e r e s o l u t i o n concluded as follows

We believe that, happily, the experiments of imperialism have come to an end, and that colonial

exploitation has passed into history. The epoch of mistrust has been closed. ... A few days have sufficed to bring about a good understanding between Americans and Filipinos, which it had been impossible to establish during the thirteen years past. We are convinced that every onward step, while relieving the American Government of its responsibilities in the Islands, will, as in the past, fully demonstrate the present capacity of the Filipino people to establish a government of its own and guarantee in a permanent manner the safety under such government of the life, property and liberty of the residents of the Islands, national as well as foreign. We do not wish to say by this that there will not be difficulties and embarrassments. Nor do we even expect that the campaign, open or concealed, of the enemies of the Filipino cause will cease soon, but we feel sure that through a conservative use of the powers entrusted to us, the Filipino people will, with God's favor and the help of America, emerge triumphantly from the test however difficult it may be. A few days later, when the Filipino majority was appointed to the commission, the new commissioners cabled their thanks to the President, accepting the offices in order to "aid the work of laying down a basis for a stable, free Filipino Government." A joint meeting of the Legislature on October 31, 1913, resolved "that the principle of immediate action has taken the place of the announcement of promises." These quotations have been given not only to show the response of the Filipino mind to the new policy, but for the light they cast upon past history in the islands. For a century at least the home government, first of Spain and then of the United States, had, in moments of liberal impulse, promised reforms and made political professions, and then turned to other matters and left the field to the forces of reaction and inaction.